

Major suit raises

This set of practice deals is about very basic bidding using only Major suit bids. The Major suits are Hearts and Spades.

The purpose of these deals is to provide practice in deciding whether to stop at a part score, bid game or bid slam. The important point is figuring out how many combined points the partnership has.

Keep in mind:

you need 26 points to make game (4♥ 4♠)

you need 33 points to make slam (6♥ 6♠)

open 1♥ or 1♠ with 13-21 points at least five of the suit

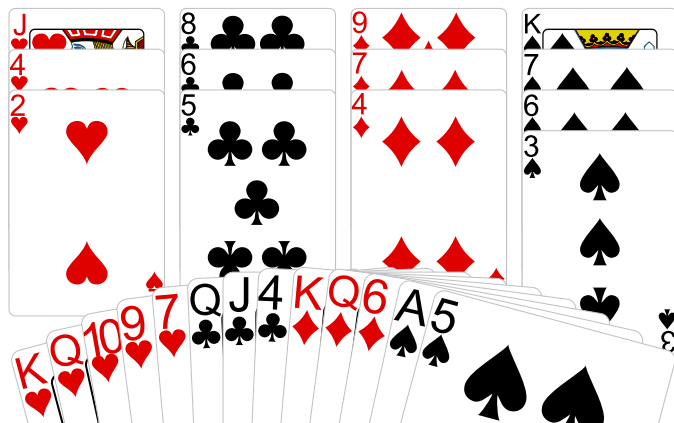
respond by raising to 2-level with 6-10 points and at least three of the suit

respond by raising to 3-level with 11-12 points and at least three of the suit

respond by raising to 4-level with 13-16 points and at least three of the suit

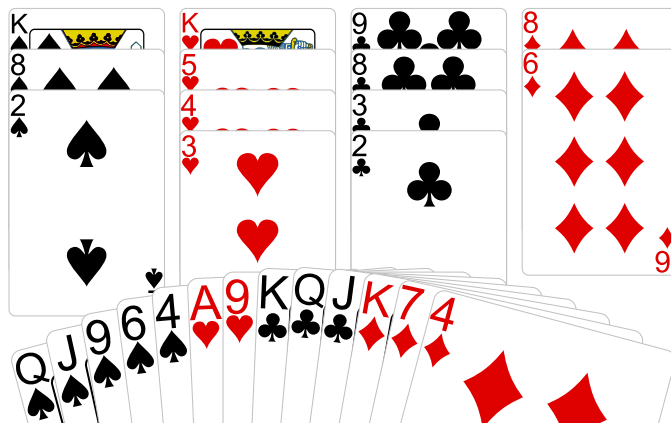
respond by raising to 4-level with 8-12 points and at least five of the suit

Deal 1 Ctr: 1♥ Goal: at most ____ losers



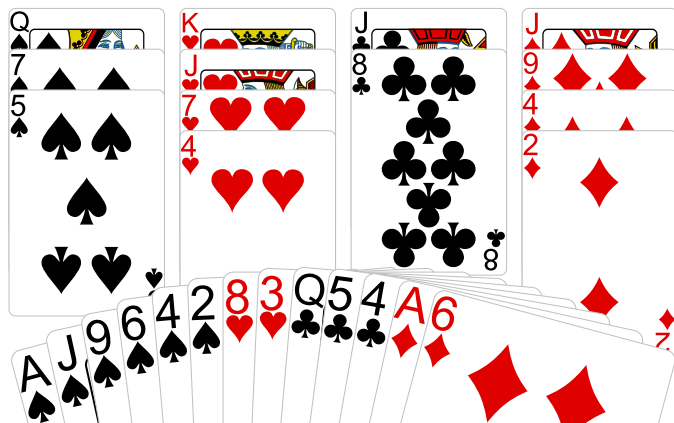
Count Fast and Slow Losers				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Reduce Losers				
Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length	

Deal 2 Ctr: 3♠ Goal: at most ____ losers



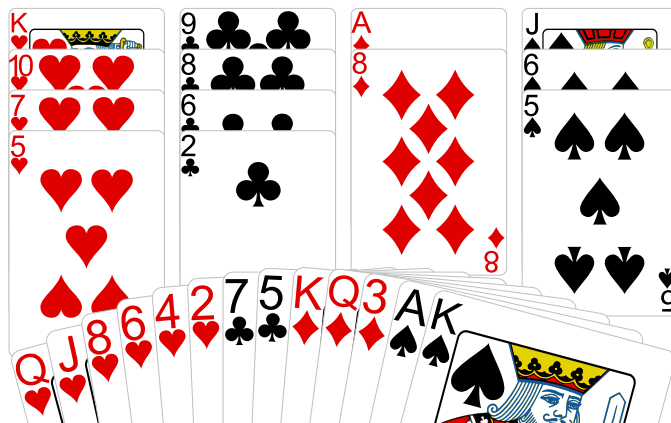
Count Fast and Slow Losers				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Reduce Losers				
Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length	

Deal 3 Ctr: 2♠ Goal: at most ____ losers



Count Fast and Slow Losers				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Reduce Losers				
Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length	

Deal 4 Ctr: 4♥ Goal: at most ____ losers



Count Fast and Slow Losers				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Reduce Losers				
Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length	

Board: 1

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 1♥

Declarer: North

Board: 2

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 3♠

Declarer: East

Board: 3

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 2♠

Declarer: South

Board: 4

Dealer: **West**

Contract: 4♥

Declarer: West

Board: 5

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 3♥

Declarer: North

Deal 1

North Deals
None Vul

♠ J 8 4
♥ A 6
♦ J 8 2
♣ A T 7 3 2

17
10 9
4

♠ A 5
♥ K Q T 9 7
♦ K Q 6
♣ Q J 4



♠ K 7 6 3
♥ J 4 2
♦ 9 7 4
♣ 8 6 5

♠ Q T 9 2
♥ 8 5 3
♦ A T 5 3
♣ K 9

Baker Bidpractice/Set2 1
NORTH has 18 points and a 5-card



suit. This is a good hand

to open 1



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West

North

East

South

SOUTH has three

1 ♥

All Pass



1 ♥ by North
s which is adequate support. But SOUTH only

has 4 points which is not strong enough to respond. So SOUTH passes.

Deal 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ K 8 2
 ♥ K 5 4 3
 ♦ 8 6
 ♣ 9 8 3 2

9
 6 16
 9

♠ T
 ♥ Q 7 2
 ♦ A Q J 9 3 2
 ♣ T 6 4



♠ A 7 5 3
 ♥ J T 8 6
 ♦ T 5
 ♣ A 7 5

♠ Q J 9 6 4
 ♥ A 9
 ♦ K 7 4
 ♣ K Q J

West	North	East	South
2 ♠	Pass	1 ♠	Pass
All Pass		3 ♠	

3 ♠ by East
more try by bidding 3 ♠.

Baker Bidpractice/Set2 2

EAST has 17 points counting 1 extra for the fifth ♠. This is a middle-range hand with five ♠s.

So he opens 1 ♠.

WEST only has 7 points, 6 in high cards and one more for the doubleton

♦

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But she does have three ♠s, so she can respond 2 ♠.

Since EAST is middle-range, he makes one

If WEST had 9 or 10 points she would now bid 4 ♠ - but with 7 she passes.

Deal 3

North Deals
None Vul

♠ K
♥ A 9 5 2
♦ Q 7 3
♣ K T 9 7 6

8
12 9
11

West

Pass

All Pass

2♠ by South
passes.

♠ Q 7 5
♥ K J 7 4
♦ J 9 4 2
♣ J 8



♠ A J 9 6 4 2
♥ 8 3
♦ A 6
♣ Q 5 4

North
Pass

2♠

East
Pass

South
1♠

Baker Bidpractice/Set2 3

With 8 points, NORTH is not strong enough to open the bidding.

SOUTH has 13 points, barely meeting the minimum for a 1-opening. Note that the fifth and

sixth ♠ each added 1 point to his count. He opens 1♠.

Although NORTH passed originally, she must respond to SOUTH's opening bid. Since she has

three ♠s she raises to 2♠.

In light of NORTH's weak response SOUTH

Deal 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ A K
♥ Q J 8 6 4 2
♦ K Q 3
♣ 7 5

8
15 8
9

♠ 7 4 3 2

♥ 9 3

♦ J 7 6 2

♣ A Q J



♠ Q T 9 8

♥ A

♦ T 9 5 4

♣ K T 4 3

♠ J 6 5
♥ K T 7 5
♦ A 8
♣ 9 8 6 2

Baker Bidpractice/Set2 4
WEST has 17 points and six



s.

This is a mid-range 1



opening bid.

West

1♥

3♥

All Pass

4♥ by West

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North

Pass

Pass

East

2♥

4♥

South

Pass

With 9 points, (1 for the doubleton), EAST
raises to 2



WEST's hand is worth one more try. He invites with 3



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EAST had a strong 2



raise, considering that she might

have only had 6 points. So she carries on to 4



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Deal 5

North Deals
None Vul

♠ A 8 5
♥ J T 9 8
♦ K Q 9
♣ 7 4 3

16
10 7
7

♠ T 9 2
♥ A K 5 4 2
♦ 8 5
♣ A K Q



♠ 7 6 4
♥ Q 7 6 3
♦ A J 4
♣ 9 8 5

♠ K Q J 3
♥ -
♦ T 7 6 3 2
♣ J T 6 2

Baker Bidpractice/Set2 5
NORTH opens 1



with 17 points and five



s.

SOUTH, with 7 points and four trumps raises to 2

West	North	East	South
	1 ♥	Pass	2 ♥
Pass	3 ♥		
All Pass			



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3 ♥ by North

NORTH has a mid-range hand, good enough to invite SOUTH to bid the game.

Too bad, but SOUTH is too weak to accept any invitations.